Skill – Religion (Intelligence) · SRD 5.2.1

Religion is used to recall **lore about gods, rites, holy symbols and cults**. It uses an **Intelligence (Religion)** check, often via the **Study** action.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **Intelligence (Religion)** check.
2. Lore: gods, rites, symbols, cults.
3. **Study** action to dig deeper.
4. DC by how rare the lore is.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 ties Religion to the Study action like the other lore skills.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't cover a specific world's gods. Fix: the DM describes their pantheon.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe a symbol or rite the character recognizes.

Step 1 – Announce:

The player says what they want to know (god, rite, symbol).

Step 2 – Study:

Study action to examine; instant recall otherwise.

Step 3 – Set the DC:

DC 10 common; 15 uncommon; 20 rare.

Step 4 – Roll:

1d20 + Intelligence + proficiency.

Step 5 – Reveal:

Success: a fact; beat by 5: an extra detail.

Example: Brann recognizes a carved symbol (DC 15). He rolls 17: it's the seal of a forgotten cult.

⚠ Common questions:

Religion or Arcana?

Religion: gods and cults; Arcana: magic and planes.

Recognize a symbol?

Yes with Religion.

Undead?

Often Religion or Arcana per the DM.

Must I be devout?

No, only proficient.

Retry?

No: knowledge doesn't change.

Does a cleric have Advantage?

No, unless a class feature says so.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Homebrew pantheons

DM's gods. **Option**: give players a summary.

Religion or History

An ancient rite. **Option**: the DM chooses.

Class lore

A cleric knows their god with no roll. **Option**: keep it.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Study

The Study action serves Intelligence skills.

Lore

It recalls knowledge, not deductions.

Symbols

Recognizing a symbol is Religion.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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